A Walk in the Park

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Created by Kevin Casas

Research and Observations

Initial Research

1. Benches

- Benches are very low to the ground, dirty
- No benches on the crossing path

2. User Retention

- People mostly walk straight through the park
- People usually don’t stick around to explore the park

3. Security

- People think about the Back Bay Fens in a negative light

Common Answers in INterviews

Reason for being in the Fens	Way of entering park
Walking to Target	Shattuck Visitor Center Entrance
Thoughts on the fens being well connected to the city	**What would you add to the fens?**
Most agreed that the Fens felt connected to the city	Benches, more clean/maintained lounging areas, public exercise events, spaces similar to Rose Garden

Further Observations & Conclusion

Playground & Victory Gardens

- No signs pointing to any locations in the park
- Playground located in isolated location
- Victory Gardens also set apart from everything

Conclusion

- People use the park mostly for a passage to locations other than the park (eg. Target, Fenway Park)
- People usually don’t stick around to explore the park

Starting Initial Design

Wayfinding Station

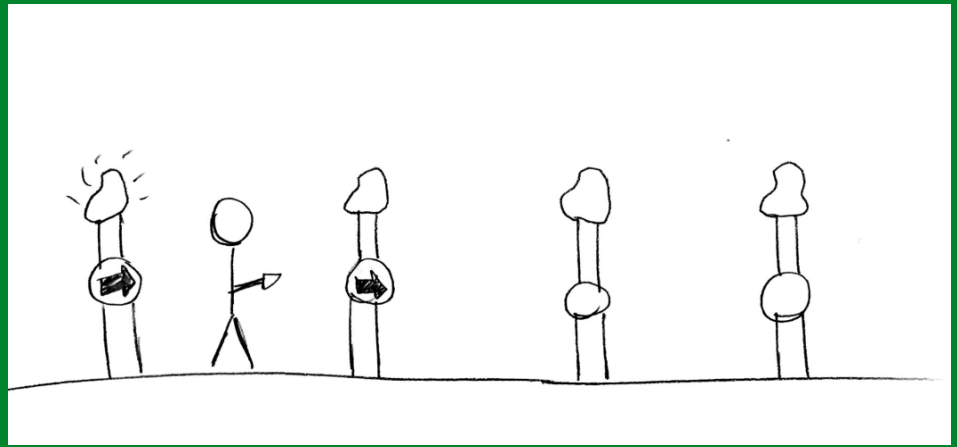
- Located at the entrances of every park in the Emerald Necklace
- Creating a simplified view of the Emerald Necklace Park System
- Showing information that is relevant to the user
- Resistive touch-screen allows for use with any press, including gloved hands in the winter
- The user can plot a destination and a path, and an RFID Tag will be distributed to the user

RFID Tags

- Disposable tickets are embedded with the path and destination the user chose
- The ticket will also be able to send data through the various markers along the path
- This data can then be used to show information on the UI at the wayfinding stations, showing popular spots in the park or where an event is taking place

Guidance System

- A companion that is guiding you to where you want to go
- Takes away the need of having your phone out to navigate
- Screens attached to light posts will activate once you get close enough with your RFID ticket
- The screen shows an arrow that points in the direction of your destination
- You can stop or pause your walk at any time by tapping your ticket against a screen



Final Designs

RFID Ticket

Emerald Necklace
CONSERVANCY

Have a nice walk in the park!

Walk by a path marker to be reminded which way to go to get to your destination.

If you want to explore the park and veer off your path, tap this card to a path marker to pause your walk.

Wayfinding Interface

Welcome to the Back Bay Fens!

Tap on any of the locations to be given more information.

Get information about other parks in the Emerald Necklace:

- Franklin Park
- Arnold Arboretum
- Jamaica Pond
- Olmsted Park
- The Riverway
- Public Garden
- Boston Common

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Kelleher Rose Garden

The Kelleher Rose Garden sits just behind a yew hedge in the Back Bay Fens and greets visitors with a dazzling display of more than 1,500 roses along its garden paths and trellises. Adding to the drama is a reconstructed 1930's-era fountain encircled by statuary.

Open from mid-April through October.

5 minute walk

Navigate Here

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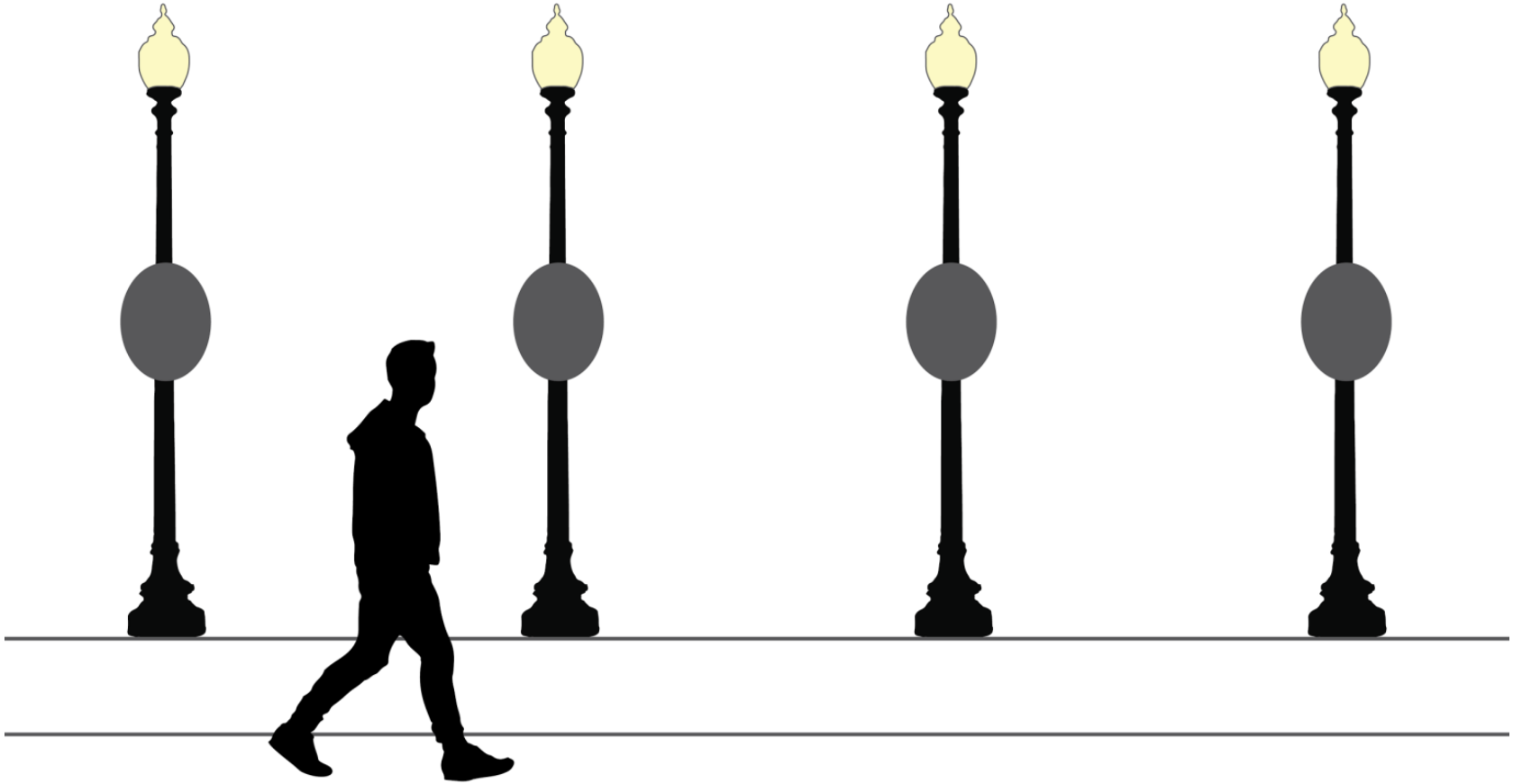
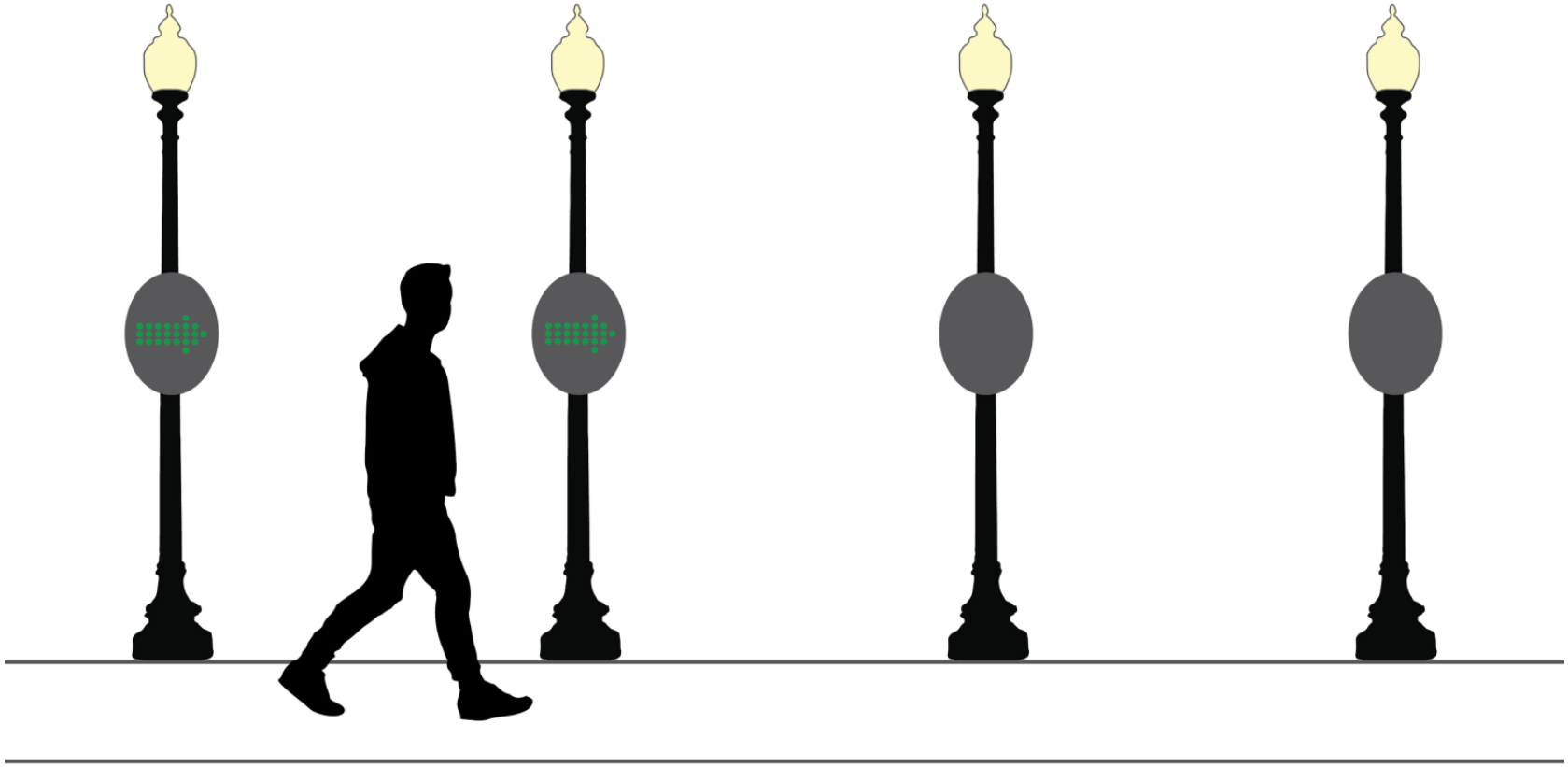
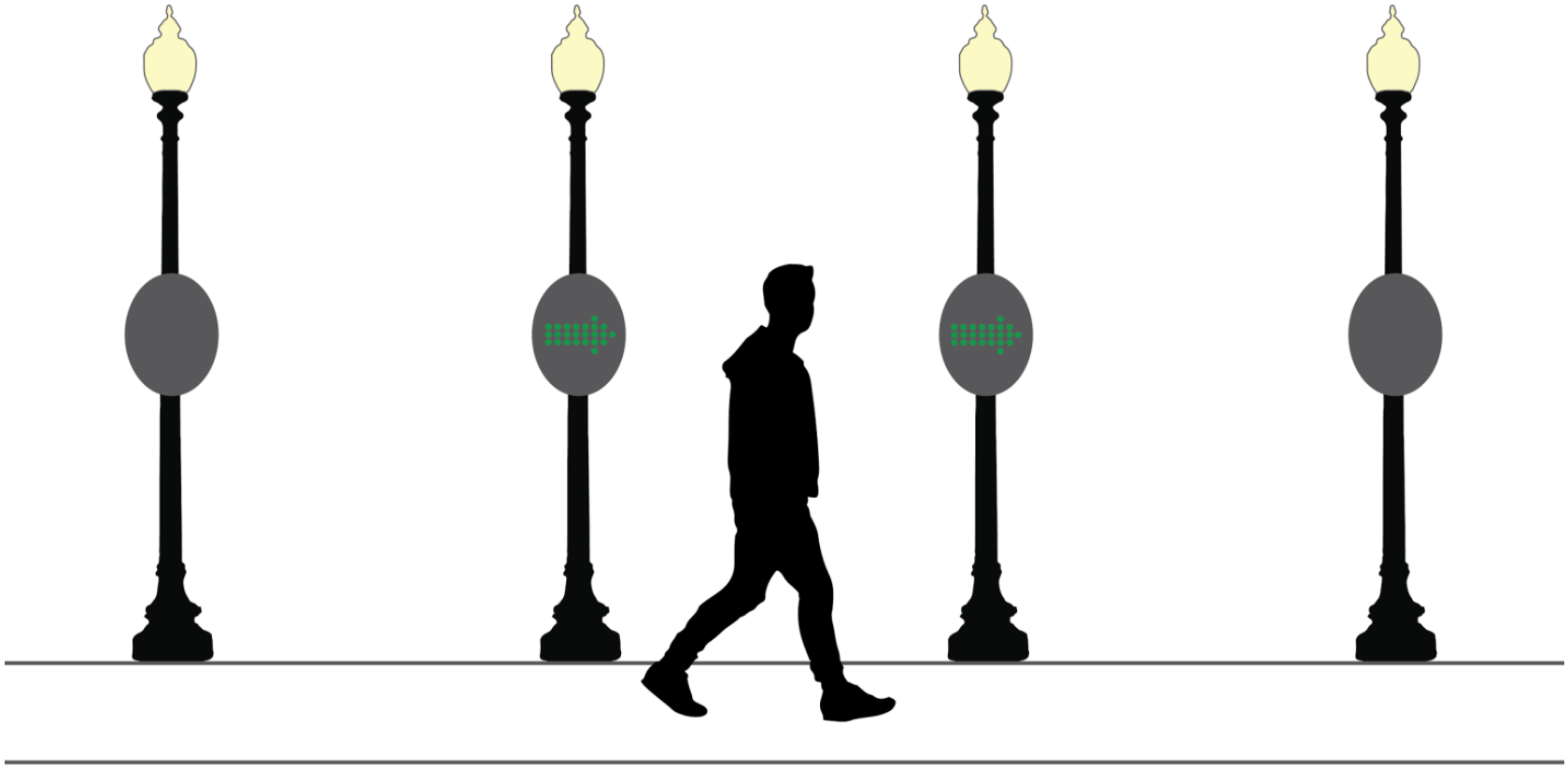
Have a nice walk in the park!

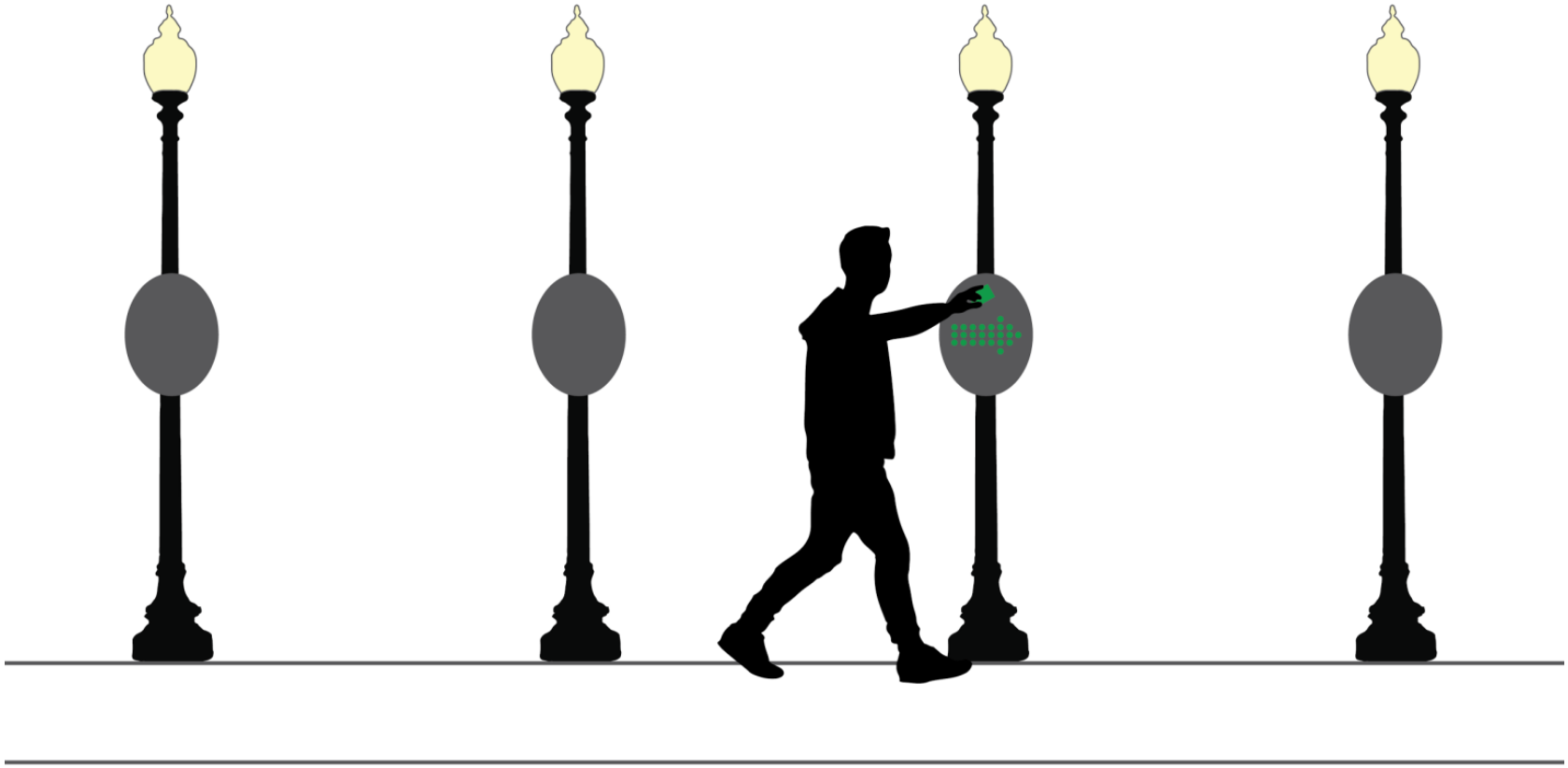
Take your printed direction card to be shown how to get to your destination!

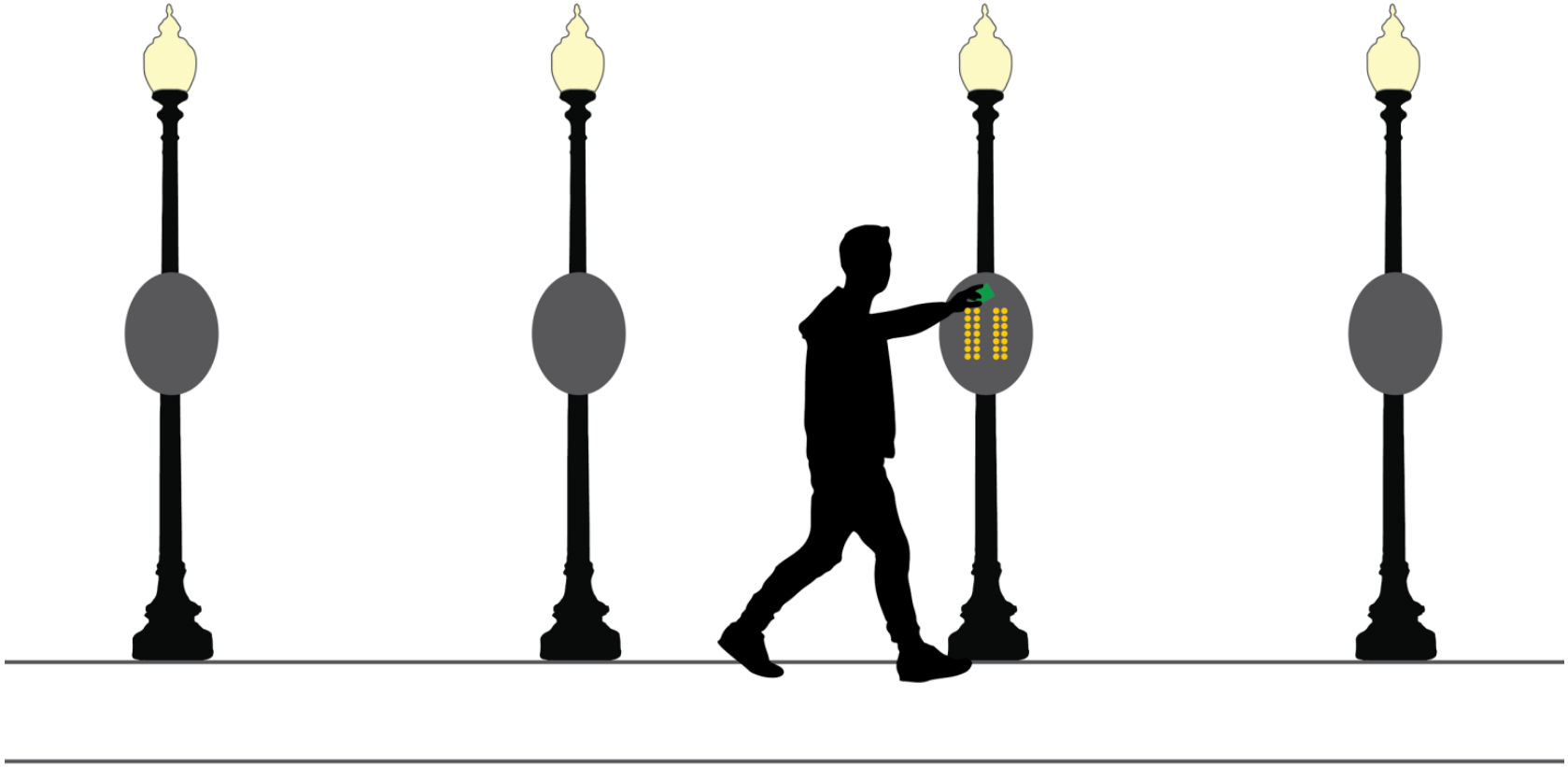
“A Walk in the Park” Experience

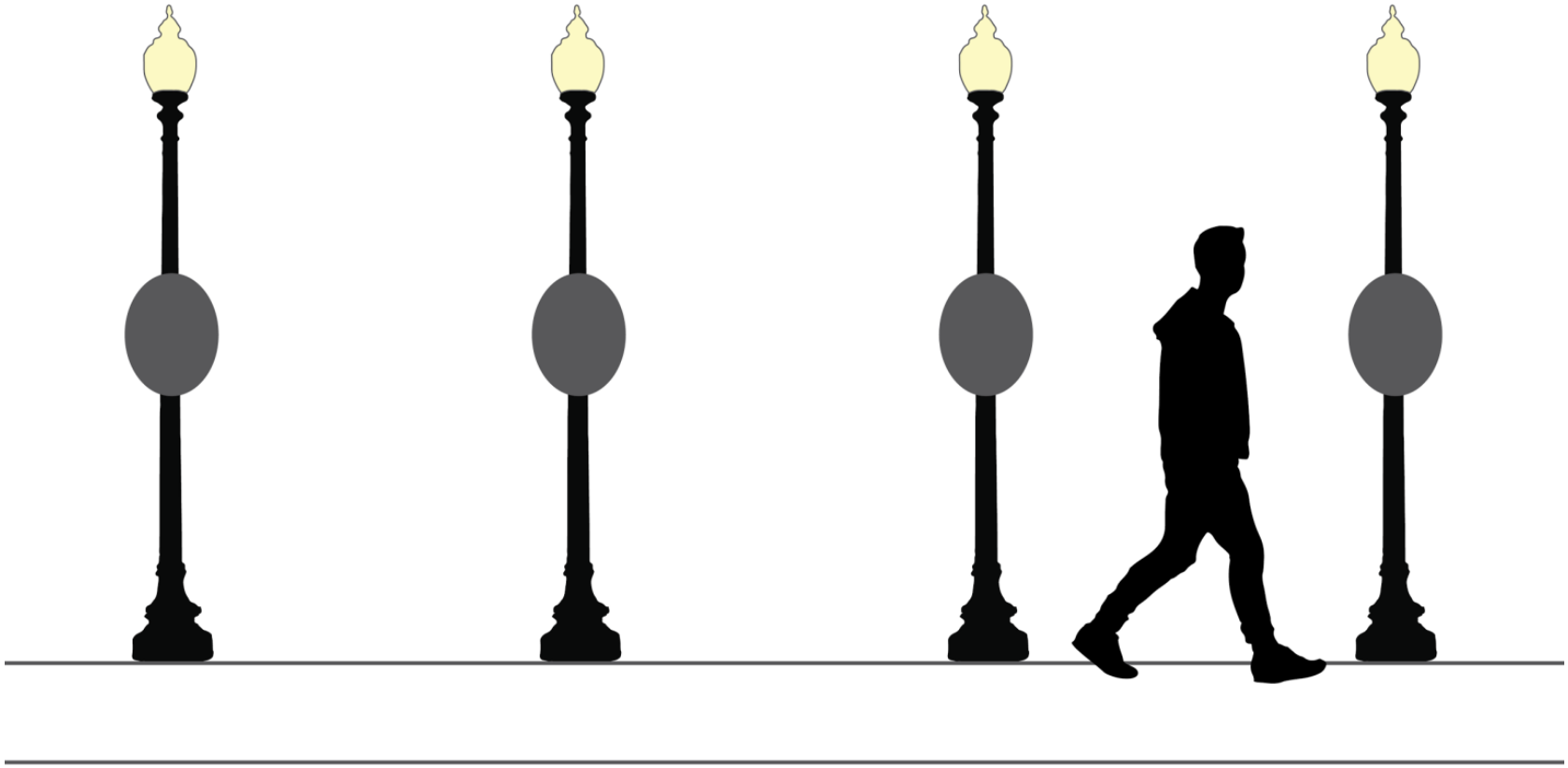


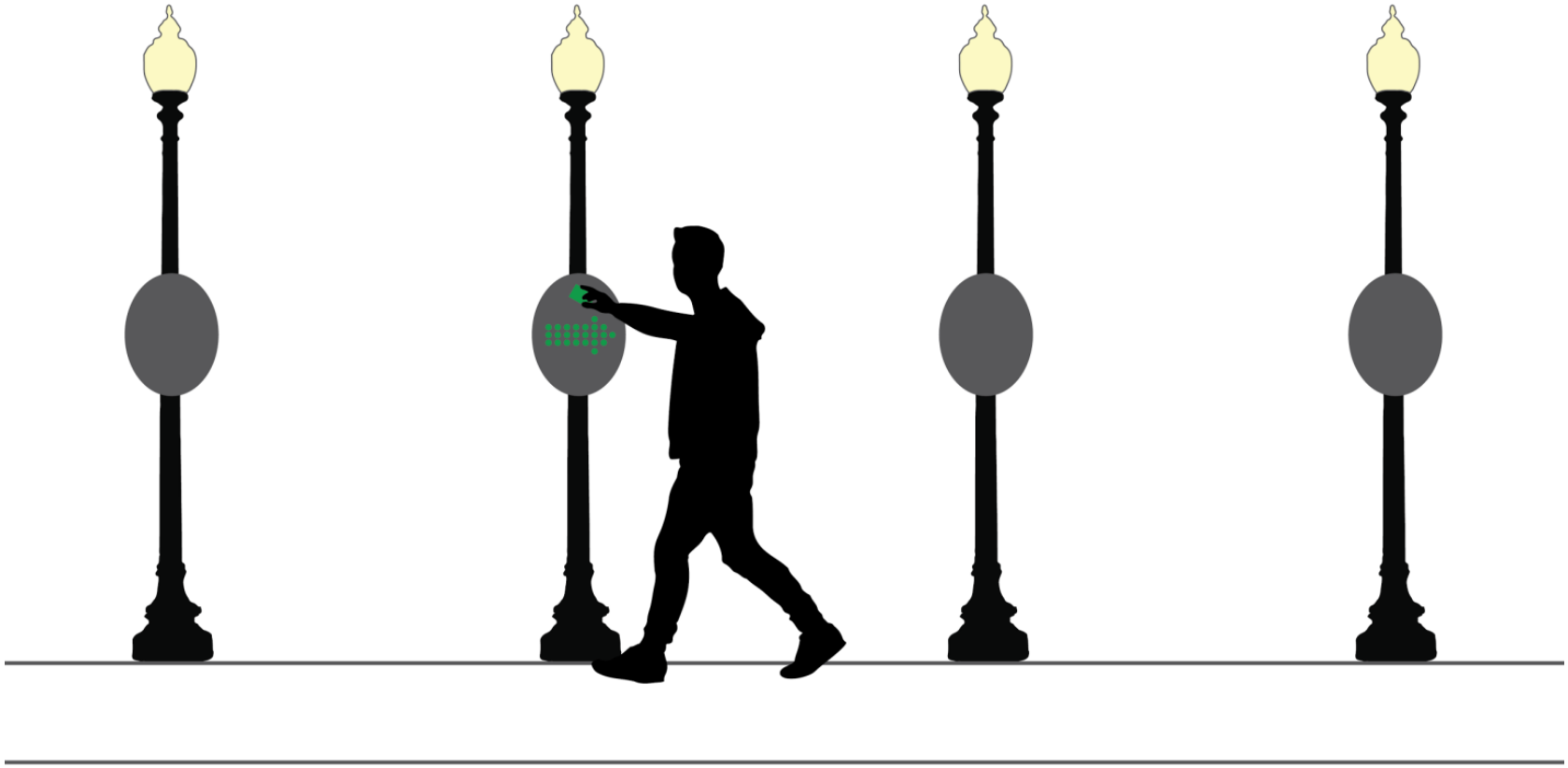












Questions?